

READING TEST (40 minutes)

In the Reading test, you will read a variety of texts and answer several different types of reading comprehension questions. There are three parts, and directions are given for each part. You are encouraged to answer as many questions as possible within the time allowed.

You must mark your answers on the separate answer sheet. Do not write your answers in your test book.

PART 5

Directions: A word or phrase is missing in each of the sentences below. Four answer choices are given below each sentence. Select the best answer to complete the sentence. Then mark the letter (A), (B), (C), or (D) on your answer sheet.

1. It was on his business trip to Rome during _____ Marcus secured several new contracts for his firm.
A. whose B. while C. whatever D. which
2. Consulting its entire staff before making crucial business decisions is a _____ that makes this company unique in its field.
A. usage B. ground C. practice D. manner
3. William Taylor had been the department manager _____ only six weeks before he was promoted to vice president.
A. for B. of C. past D. when
4. That problem occurred so _____ that it wasn't even covered in the operations manual.
A. hardly B. uneasily C. weakly D. infrequently
5. In typical years, less than half of the people who apply are _____ to the graduate school.
A. admit B. admits C. admitted D. admitting
6. Since _____ the union and the company wanted to get the most advantageous deal, it was difficult for them to compromise.
A. both B. also C. either D. too
7. Any passenger without a _____ pass will not be allowed onto the airplane.
A. boarded B. boarding C. to board D. boards

8. The company has made an important discovery _____ should help to revolutionize the computer industry.
A. those B. what C. that D. where
9. The mechanic was able to repair the vehicle by using the spare _____ which were lying around his garage.
A. amounts B. types C. kinds D. parts
10. While the organizers of the conference _____ anticipated 500 people would attend, more than double that number actually appeared.
A. original B. originality C. originated D. originally
11. As a result of the recent elections, the government _____ to pay more attention to domestic issues.
A. expects B. is expecting C. expected D. is expected
12. The engine oil is _____ keeps an engine's components and gears smoothly operating.
A. who B. which C. what D. why
13. Although Tina Martin only stepped _____ for a while, there were several messages waiting for her upon her return to the office.
A. through B. along C. out D. aside
14. Kevin was interested in finding a job with the government _____ Scott was more interested in the private sector.
A. how B. while C. that D. so
15. Avery Johnson considers _____ the most important worker in his department.
A. he B. him C. his D. himself
16. _____ the next two weeks, the store will be undergoing renovations and will be open on a limited basis only.
A. Among B. Over C. Beyond D. Behind
17. There had been a lot of time and money _____ in Dr. Baldwin's research, so the CEO was reluctant to cancel the program.
A. invest B. invested C. investor D. investing

18. This section is the ticket stub, which you must not _____ before entering the theater.

- A. correspond B. write C. detach D. withdraw

19. As the _____ has already been accepted by the president, its implementation now depends on the support of a majority of the board.

- A. proposal B. intention C. indication D. advice

20. We have _____ comparatively less of the national budget on funding research and development than all our neighbors and most of Europe.

- A. bought B. cashed C. spent D. afforded

21. Due to the most recent increase in freight rates, we find it _____ to raise our prices on Brazilian coffee.

- A. necessary B. necessarily C. necessity D. necessitate

22. Representatives of both sides had _____ had two meetings at the time the union declared the walkout.

- A. already B. since C. still D. yet

23. The trees along the street _____ to be watered at least once a week.

- A. needs B. need C. needing D. to need

24. Please complete all the sections on the reverse side of this form, and return it to us in the _____ provided.

- A. stamp B. postage C. address D. envelope

25. Anyone who is over the age of 16 is _____ to take part in the contest.

- A. reliable B. voluntary C. eligible D. contrary

26. The inspector _____ the plant manager about the sanitary conditions of the factory.

- A. requested B. succeeded C. reached D. questioned

27. _____ the soaring increases in sales, the staff members were given no compensation for their efforts.

- A. Although B. Because of C. While D. Despite

28. There won't be any problem if you comply _____ the company policy.

- A. with B. to C. as D. under

29. He was hoping to find a _____ price, new car.

- A. decent B. good C. cheap D. reasonably

30. Something went wrong with the stage set; _____, the show began 30 minutes later.

- A. furthermore B. in addition C. therefore D. because

PART 6

Directions: Read the texts that follow. A word, phrase, or sentence is missing in parts of each text. Four answer choices for each of the sentences are given below. Select the best answer to complete the text.

Then mark the letter (A), (B), (C), or (D) on your answer sheet.

Questions 31-34 refer to the following email.

To: Kendrick Nelson <knelson@hamptonsteel.com>

From: Patricia Rhodes <patriciarhodes@hamptonsteel.com>

Subject: Next Week

Date: May 12

Dear Mr. Nelson,

---[31]--- I have been informed by my doctor that I must undergo a surgical ---[32]--- this weekend. I will be hospitalized for roughly three days and have to remain in bed for a few days afterward. As such, I will be unable ---[33]--- my job duties next week. I believe I have enough sick days remaining this year, so I would like to be paid during my time away from the office. Would you please confirm that this is acceptable? I spoke with my manager, Fred Olsen, regarding this matter, and he ---[34]--- me to contact you.

Regards,

Patricia Rhodes

Acquisitions Department

31.

- (A) I will no longer be working here after this week.
- (B) I'm interested in transferring to another department.
- (C) I'd like to take a trip for a few days.
- (D) I would like to request a one-week leave of absence.

32.

- (A) proceeding
- (B) procedure
- (C) proceeded
- (D) proceed

33.

- (A) conduct
- (B) conducting
- (C) to conduct
- (D) be conducted

34.

- (A) said
- (B) advised
- (C) suggested
- (D) recommended

Questions 35-38 refer to the following article.

Arlington (March 12) - After a long delay, the repairs on the Arlington Civic Center have finally been completed, and the building has reopened ---[35]--- business. ---[36]--- It was attended by the center's president, Marcia Snyder, and other local residents. The center was devastated by a fire seven months ago and had to undergo extensive ---[37]--- Ms. Snyder stated that businesses and organizations have once again been calling to reserve the center for various events. She added that the first event – a fundraiser – would be held on Thursday evening. It is expected that the center will quickly regain the popularity it had before it was ---[38]---

35.

- (A) for
- (B) in
- (C) with
- (D) by

36.

- (A) A group will hold a convention there tonight.
- (B) A special event honoring this will take place tomorrow.
- (C) The center is just about ready to accept clients.
- (D) A ceremony was held on Tuesday morning.

37.

- (A) renovates
- (B) renovations
- (C) renovators
- (D) renovated

38.

- (A) repaired
- (B) designed
- (C) damaged
- (D) funded

PART 7

Directions: In this part you will read a selection of texts, such as magazine and newspaper articles, letters, and advertisements. Each text is followed by several questions. Select the best answer for each question and mark the letters (A), (B), (C), or (D) on your answer sheet.

Questions 39-41 refer to the following text message chain.

Leeroy Jones [11:30]

Hi, Bill. Are you at headquarters?

Bill Henderson [11:32]

Not yet. I'm heading there now, why?

Leeroy Jones [11:34]

We're almost out of paint for the living room walls here at 56 Larkin Street. Do we have enough budget left for some extra tins? I can buy them at the store on Garvey Road.

Bill Henderson [11:35]

Susanna is in control of project budgets. I'll add her now. How much do you need to spend?

Leeroy Jones [11:37]

It won't be more than thirty.

Susanna Potts [11:39]

We can manage that.

Leeroy Jones [11:40]

Thanks. Then I'll go and get them now.

Bill Henderson [11:43]

Hold on. I'm on my way to some jobs on Jolie Crescent and Mormont Road, so I can stop by the store for you. Then I'll bring you what you need before I go to my jobs.

Leeroy Jones [11:44]

Thanks a lot. Susanna, please just make a note of the extra expense in the project log book.

Susanna Potts [11:46]

Of course. Good luck with the rest of the work.

39. What type of business does Mr. Jones probably work for?

- (A) A hardware store
- (B) An architecture firm
- (C) A decorating company
- (D) A real estate agency

40. At 11:39 A.M., what does Ms. Potts most likely mean when she writes, “We can manage that”?

- (A) A new project will soon begin.
- (B) She does not require any assistance with a task.
- (C) She thinks a deadline will be easy to meet.
- (D) There is enough money for some items.

41. Where will Mr. Henderson most likely go next?

- (A) To Larkin Street
- (B) To Garvey Road
- (C) To Jolie Crescent
- (D) To Mormont Road

Questions 42-45 refer to the following letter.

Dear Manager,

During the past three months, I have placed two sizable orders for The Handy Writer's Companion, by Perot, specifying the new spiral binding that you are advertising in Publisher's Weekly. Both times you sent me the hardcover binding because you were out of stock on the spiral.

Fortunately, I am still selling quite a few of the hardcovers, but more and more customers are asking for the new spiral-bound book (at least two of your competitors have similar books in this easy-to-use binding).

I'm frankly concerned that unless you solve this out-of-stock problem, we're both going to be hurt. Up to now I have stocked only the Perot book – my customers tell me it is the best of its kind on the market – but I may have to change my policy. It may sound a little foolish that people will choose a book because it's easier to use rather than on the merits of the content, but it really seems to be happening.

Enclosed is my order for 75 copies of The Handy Writer's Companion in spiral binding. Please do not, under any circumstances, send me anything else. I have plenty of the hardcover copies in stock.

The new Recipe Date Book is a winner. I sold 162 of them in April and will soon have to place another order. Please don't be out of stock!

Sincerely yours,

Mary Beth Laughlin

42. To whom is this letter written?

- (A) bookbinder
- (B) A publisher
- (C) An author
- (D) An editor

43. Why was this letter written?

- (A) To return some books
- (B) To ensure a specific product delivery
- (C) To ask for a discount
- (D) To exchange some books for more popular editions

44. Why do customers prefer the spiral-bound book?

- (A) It is convenient.
- (B) It is updated.
- (C) It is hard to get.
- (D) It is easy to read.

45. What is sent with this letter?

- (A) Hardcover books that were not sold.
- (B) An order cancellation
- (C) An order sheet
- (D) Sample copies of a new book

Questions 46-50 refer to the following memorandum and email.

To: All staff

From: Florence Carter

Re: Job openings

Because the company is going to be expanding a number of its services, we will be hiring over fifty new employees. We will be adding many new positions in the Manufacturing, Customer Relations, Human Resources, Sales, and Marketing Departments. Attached to this memo is a complete list of all the jobs that are being offered along with a description of the responsibilities, the requirements, the salaries, and the benefits for each job. Many of the jobs being offered are at higher levels than the ones you may currently have. If possible, I would prefer to fill these jobs from inside the company. I'm sure that many of you would welcome the opportunity for a promotion as well as the extra benefits that they will provide as well. Please take the time to look over the list of jobs, and find the ones you may be interested in. Then send me an e-mail with your résumé attached. Be sure to state clearly for which job you are applying. And there is no need to be overly formal. Sending your documents by e-mail is perfectly acceptable. You don't need to send me the paper versions. The lack of formality will not be held against you.

E-mail

To: florencec@companymail.com

From: bernardq@companymail.com

Subject: Job openings

Date: Thursday, December 10

Florence,

I just got your memo a day ago, and I have been reading through all the job openings. However, I have a few questions that I hope you don't mind answering for me. As you know, I've worked at this company for around ten months. When I signed my contract to work here, one of the stipulations was that I was put on a probation period of one year. Then, after one year, my job performance would be evaluated, and I would either be retained or be terminated from my position.

One of the stipulations in my contract was that I was ineligible both for promotions and transfers within the company until my probation period was over. However, there are several positions for which I believe I am qualified and that I am interested in applying

for. This is where my problem lies. Under the terms of my current agreement, I am forbidden from changing jobs for two more months. But I feel that the company's expansion is an extenuating circumstance and something unlikely to occur again.

I am therefore curious if the rules could possibly be changed for me. Perhaps I could have my evaluation done earlier than the one-year mark of my employment. I have consistently received positive evaluations, and I'm sure that I will be retained. Or perhaps the rules could be changed just once to allow me to compete for one of these new jobs. I know that this is an unusual request, but I think these are unusual circumstances. I'd like to discuss this matter with you at some time. Please contact me at your leisure so that we can set up a time to meet.

Thanks.

Bernard Quinlan

46. What does Florence Carter ask the recipients of the memo to do?

- (A) Look at the job openings
- (B) Consider seeking employment elsewhere
- (C) Apply for a promotion
- (D) Mark all the jobs for which they are qualified

47. How would Florence Carter like to fill the new positions?

- (A) By using a job placement agency
- (B) By transferring workers from other departments
- (C) By employing current workers
- (D) By hiring new employees

48. What will happen to Bernard Quinlan when he has been employed for one year?

- (A) He will be given a new contract.
- (B) He will be let go from his position.
- (C) He will be given a raise and a promotion.
- (D) He will be evaluated on his performance

49. What does Bernard Quinlan request that Florence Carter do for him?

- (A) Allow him to apply for a different job
- (B) Evaluate his performance next week
- (C) Talk to his supervisors about his performance
- (D) Let him know for which jobs he is qualified

50. Why does Bernard Quinlan make this special request?

- (A) He doesn't enjoy working for his current supervisor.
- (B) He feels that this situation won't happen again.
- (C) He knows he is better than the others applying for jobs.
- (D) He thinks he deserves a promotion.